

# The Fed Put in General Equilibrium

José Zóbarán & João Pedro Tedesco

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## 1 Introduction

Should central banks react to asset prices? And if so, to which extent? This question has always occupied economists' minds whenever large, generalized swings in equity valuations take place in the economy. The traditional policy view holds that, although asset prices may contain information about future economic conditions, they should not enter the monetary rule as independent targets. Yet, the experience of recent decades in the United States has kept alive the perception that central banks do in fact respond to financial market conditions, and respond particularly strongly when asset prices fall (not vary) sharply – a phenomenon often referred to as the "Fed Put".

This has first been brought to economic academia in the seminal papers by ??, but as the literature on this subject developed, a key distinction has often been blurred. Most macroeconomic models that study monetary responses to asset prices do so through symmetric policy rules, under which the central bank acts on both increases and decreases in market valuations, rather than an inherently asymmetrical "put" behavior. Our objective in this research is to model this policy rule and evaluate its implications for output, inflation and asset price volatility, as well as determine the policy implications derived from this incorporation.

We do so by adding a risky asset (following the logic of a Lucas Tree) in a Representative Agent New Keynesian Model. The construction is intentionally parsimonious in order to isolate the mechanism through which monetary policy reacts to financial valuations under this specification. We begin by solving a benchmark model in which the central bank responds symmetrically to asset-price deviations. We obtain a closed-form solution that clarifies a tradeoff that is present, but only implicitly, in much of the earlier literature: reacting to asset prices can help stabilize the economy when asset-price fluctuations reflect real disturbances, but it can also transmit otherwise "pure" financial shocks into inflation and real

activity. We then replace the symmetric rule with an asymmetric policy rule that reacts only to asset-price shortfalls. As the policy response is nonlinear, it is analyzed numerically.

The main result is that modest asset-price reactivity can improve stabilization outcomes, but the effects depend importantly on whether the policy rule is symmetric or asymmetric. In particular, while symmetric responses may deliver larger gains in some regions of the parameter space, asymmetric rules are more robust when the central bank reacts more aggressively. We aim, then, to contribute not only to the debate over whether monetary policy should respond to asset prices, but also to a more precise characterization of how such a response should be modeled.

This paper contributes to the literature on asset prices and monetary policy. The seminal contributions of ?? argue against direct asset-price targeting and instead favor focusing monetary policy on standard macroeconomic objectives. ? reach a similar conclusion, while ? and ? emphasize that reacting to equity prices may also create undesirable equilibrium dynamics by making determinacy harder to achieve.

Other contributions are more favorable to asset-price reactions. ? argue that policy may benefit from responding to asset prices when central banks can identify misalignments, while ? stresses the informational content of asset prices and financial imbalances for policy. More structural support for such responses appears in models where financial valuations affect aggregate demand more directly, as in ? and ?.

This paper is also related to the empirical and finance literature on the Fed put. ? set up a NLP study of FOMC meeting transcripts that provides evidence that monetary policy responds asymmetrically to adverse stock-market movements, suggesting that the relevant positive policy object is not a symmetric reaction to asset prices, but rather a downside-oriented intervention. They further show that asset price shortfalls comove with downgrades in the Fed's growth outlook, and investigate whether this response is due to the Fed incorporating markets information (i.e a prediction channel) or a wealth effect of valuations on consumption, finding support for the latter. The existence of this wealth channel is documented by several works (?, ?, ?). Most notably, ? estimates valuation gains impact MPCs to the tune of 20%, even when unrealized.

The latest addition to this family of work comes from ?, who builds an asset pricing model that accounts for how prices would incorporate the Fed's reaction. They find that expectations of monetary support raises valuations in all states of the world, and that in bad states it delivers prices 20% higher than otherwise. It is also the one other work (besides ? to differentiate between a "Fed put" and a "Fed call", and provide evidence against the latter. However, by sticking to a limited modeling of the economy it is unable to deliver results for inflation, output and welfare more generally.

Our contribution to this literature is twofold. First, we provide a closed-form characterization of the symmetric asset-price rule usually studied in earlier work, making its stabilization tradeoffs more transparent. Second, we depart from that benchmark by analyzing a genuinely asymmetric put-like rule, closer in spirit to the policy behavior highlighted in the empirical literature. In this way, the paper shows that the distinction between symmetric asset-price targeting and an asymmetric Fed put is both qualitative and quantitatively important.

The rest of this paper proceeds as follows: Section 2 describes our model setup; Section 3 solves it; Section 4 presents main results and implications; and Section 5 concludes and discusses avenues for further work.

## 2 The Model

We develop a baseline New Keynesian model with a representative household with two modifications. First, we introduce a risky asset in the form of a Lucas tree. Second, we alter the monetary rule such that it may react to asset price shortfalls (the “Fed put”). We also solve a version of the model where the reaction is symmetric (echoing Bernanke (2001)), which would be better described as a “Fed put-call spread”.

### 2.1 Households

A representative household maximizes

$$\mathbb{E}_0 \sum_{t=0}^{\infty} \beta^t Z_t \left( \frac{C_t^{1-\sigma}}{1-\sigma} - \frac{N_t^{1+\varphi}}{1+\varphi} \right), \quad (1)$$

where  $Z_t$  is a demand shock; subject to the budget constraint

$$C_t + M_t S_t + Q_t B_t \leq W_t N_t + B_{t-1} + (M_t + D_t) S_{t-1} + L_t + T_t, \quad (2)$$

where  $B_t$  and  $Q_t$  denote safe, government bond holdings and their prices,  $M_t$  the price of the Lucas tree,  $D_t$  its dividend,  $S_t$  its holdings, and  $L_t$  and  $T_t$  are lump sum profits and net fiscal transfers, respectively. Letting lowercase letters denote their real counterparts, first-order

conditions yield:

$$Q_t = \beta \mathbb{E}_t \left[ \frac{C_{t+1}^{-\sigma}}{C_t^{-\sigma}} \frac{1}{\Pi_{t+1}} \frac{Z_{t+1}}{Z_t} \right], \quad (3)$$

$$w_t = C_t^\sigma N_t^\varphi, \quad (4)$$

$$m_t = Q_t \mathbb{E}_t [\Pi_{t+1} (m_{t+1} + d_{t+1})]. \quad (5)$$

Where  $\Pi_{t+1} = \frac{P_{t+1}}{P_t}$  is the gross inflation for the  $t + 1$  period.

## 2.2 Firms

Final-good firms are competitive and aggregate differentiated goods using a Dixit-Stiglitz aggregator. Intermediate firms produce with decreasing returns:

$$Y_t(j) = A_t N_t(j)^{1-\alpha}, \quad (6)$$

and set prices subject to Calvo frictions. Standard arguments yield a New Keynesian Phillips Curve relating inflation to real marginal costs.

## 2.3 Monetary Policy

Let  $\tilde{x}_t \equiv x_t - x_t^n$  denote the log difference of a variable to its natural level. The central bank follows a Taylor rule augmented with an asymmetric response to asset price shortfalls, subject to zero-mean gaussian shocks. Under zero inflation targeting, in logs:

$$i_t = r^{ss} + \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_y \tilde{y}_t + \phi_m \psi_t + u_t, \quad (7)$$

where

$$\psi_t = \min\{0, \tilde{m}_t\}. \quad (8)$$

This embeds the Fed put: monetary policy responds to asset prices only when they fall below equilibrium.

## 2.4 Exogenous Processes

Log productivity, real dividend yield, demand and monetary shocks follow processes:

$$a_t = \rho_a a_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t^a, \quad (9)$$

$$d_t = (1 - \rho_d) d^{ss} + \rho_d d_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t^d, \quad (10)$$

$$z_t = \rho_z z_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t^z, \quad (11)$$

$$u_t = \rho_u u_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t^u \quad (12)$$

## 2.5 Equilibrium

Goods market clearing requires  $Y_t = C_t$ , and we normalize the tree's holding to one.

The natural rate is standard, given by

$$r_t^n = \rho + \sigma \mathbb{E}_t \Delta y_{t+1}^n - \mathbb{E}_t \Delta z_{t+1} \quad (13)$$

## 2.6 Log-linearized system

IS curve

$$\tilde{y}_t = \mathbb{E}_t \tilde{y}_{t+1} - \frac{1}{\sigma} (i_t - \mathbb{E}_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n) \quad (14)$$

Phillips curve

$$\pi_t = \beta \mathbb{E}_t \pi_{t+1} + \kappa \tilde{y}_t \quad (15)$$

Asset pricing

$$\tilde{m}_t = \mu \mathbb{E}_t [\tilde{m}_{t+1}] + (1 - \mu) \mathbb{E}_t [\tilde{d}_{t+1}] - (i_t - \mathbb{E}_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n) \quad (16)$$

Where  $\mu = \frac{m^{ss}}{m^{ss} + d^{ss}}$

Policy rule

$$i_t = \rho + \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_y \tilde{y}_t + \phi_m \psi_t + u_t \quad (17)$$

$$(18)$$

The equilibrium characterization that emerges is mostly standard:

It is immediately clear that the tree's dividend and price do not impact consumption choices directly. The macro block is shielded from the financial block, but affects it via both

interest rates and inflation. This is because the representative agent does not treat positive dividend shocks as wealth, anticipating future bad times (and vice versa). A future extension would be managing to create this interaction by means of a more sophisticated modeling of assets.

## 2.7 Occasionally binding structure

The presence of  $\psi_t$  introduces a nonlinearity. The model admits a piecewise-linear representation:

**Regime 1 (no support):**

$$\tilde{m}_t \geq 0 \Rightarrow \psi_t = 0$$

Policy reduces to standard rules.

**Regime 2 (put active):**

$$\tilde{m}_t < 0 \Rightarrow \psi_t = -\tilde{m}_t$$

Policy responds directly to asset price deviations.

Thus, equilibrium dynamics are governed by a system with occasionally binding constraints.

## 3 Solving the Symmetric Case

A simpler version of the monetary rule is achieved by allowing responses to both positive and negative asset price deviations from equilibrium. This has the added bonus of providing a benchmark and being more directly comparable to the previous literature. The Rational Expectations equilibrium becomes:

$$\text{IS : } \tilde{y}_t = \mathbb{E}_t \tilde{y}_{t+1} - \frac{1}{\sigma} (i_t - \mathbb{E}_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n) \quad (19)$$

$$\text{NKPC : } \pi_t = \beta \mathbb{E}_t \pi_{t+1} + \kappa \tilde{y}_t \quad (20)$$

$$\text{AP : } \tilde{m}_t = \mu \mathbb{E}_t [\tilde{m}_{t+1}] + (1 - \mu) \mathbb{E}_t [\tilde{d}_{t+1}] - (i_t - \mathbb{E}_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n) \quad (21)$$

$$\text{MR : } i_t = \rho + \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_y \tilde{y}_t + \phi_m \tilde{m}_t + u_t \quad (22)$$

$$(23)$$

Demand and productivity shocks enter only through the natural rate. Seeking a solution of the form

$$\tilde{y}_t = a_r r_t^n + a_u u_t + a_d d_t \quad (24)$$

$$\pi_t = b_r r_t^n + b_u u_t + b_d d_t \quad (25)$$

$$\tilde{m}_t = c_r r_t^n + c_u u_t + c_d d_t \quad (26)$$

We find that a nonzero  $\phi_m$  appears with a positive sign on the denominator for all of the natural rate and monetary shocks coefficients, thus making them smaller; and it appears on both both numerator and denominator for  $a_d$  and  $b_d$ , making them positive (see Appendix A for a full proof).

As asset prices move due to both real (i.e natural rate) and financial (dividend) shocks, a monetary policy that responds to them has ambiguous effects on the economy. On the one hand, the reaction to real shocks is amplified, which reduces the variance of both  $\tilde{y}_t$  and  $\pi_t$  (the denominator effect). On the other, financial shocks are now transmitted to the real economy when they would otherwise be neutral, which increases both variances.

These findings rationalize the simulations conducted by Bernanke & Gertler (2001). When discussing their results that reactions to asset prices may improve economic outcomes, they state:

”Our interpretation of this effect is as follows: A shock to stock prices may temporarily change the natural real rate of interest, a change that in principle should be accommodated by a fully optimal policy rule. Putting a small weight on stock prices therefore may help a bit, at least in some circumstances and on some dimensions”

By making an analytical solution more manageable, we prove their interpretation to be accurate and provide the precise mechanisms through which it manifests itself.

## 4 Policy Rules Comparison

We now move on to implementing the asymmetric, put-like reaction function. We do not provide a closed-form result, but rather simulate the model under standard calibrations for primitives (presented on Appendix B) and fixed coefficients for reactions to inflation and the output gap.

This allows for the numerical computation of both unconditional moments and impulse response functions. We then compare these to the closed-form results obtained for standard

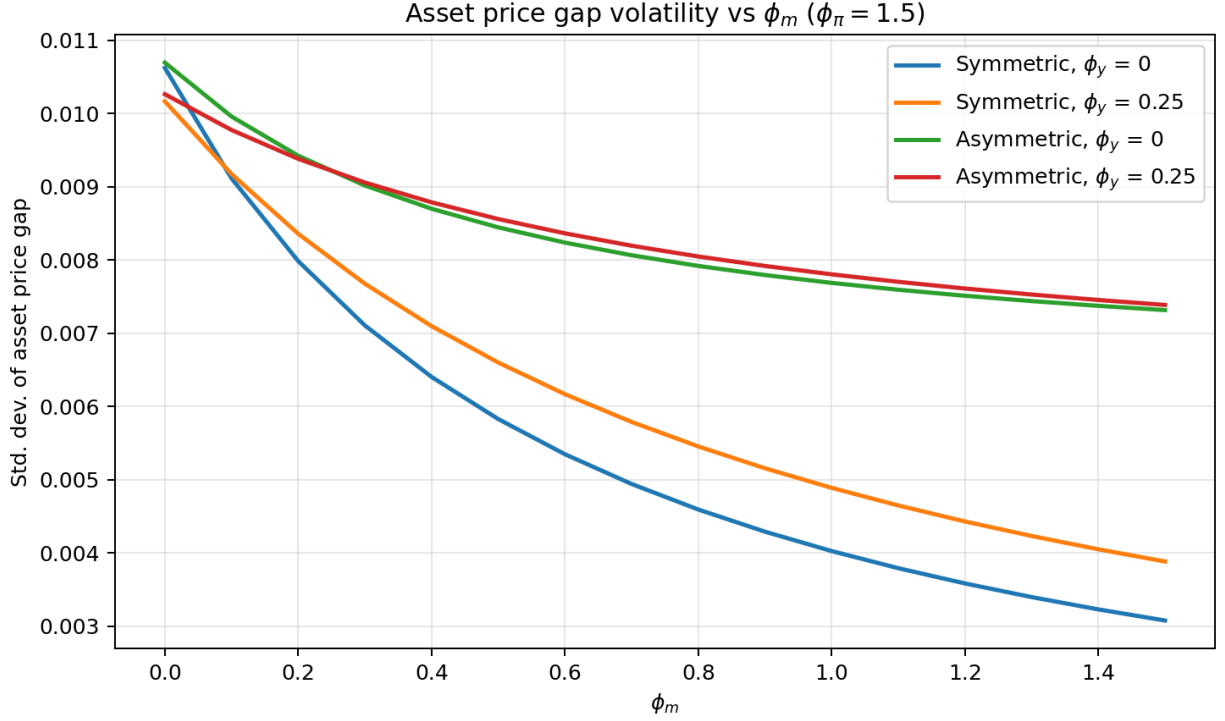


Figure 1: Asset price volatility different under monetary rules

and symmetric policy rules.

#### 4.1 Standard Deviation Comparison

Figures 1 through 3 plot how the standard deviation for asset prices, inflation and the output gap varies as  $\phi_m$  increases. For a better understanding of the effects of different policy rules, we implement four versions. The first, in blue in all figures, stands for a central bank that reacts only to inflation under  $\phi_m = 0$  (which corresponds to the Y-axis), and then reacts symmetrically to asset prices under positive  $\phi_m$ . For the second, in orange, we add set the reaction to output gap,  $\phi_y$ , to 0.25 and retain the symmetric response to asset prices. The third, in green, and fourth, in red, are the asymmetric versions of the first and second respectively. As a first pass test of our implementation, we confirm that rules 1 and 3 and 2 and 4 deliver the same results under  $\phi_m = 0$ .

Asset price volatility is monotonically decreasing in  $\phi_m$ , as we would expect. It is interesting that the *symmetric* rule delivers lower volatility. As it reacts to both positive and negative shocks, it compresses asset price movements more so than the asymmetric rule. This is not necessarily a good thing: even an investor that dislikes volatility would probably be happy if that volatility is heavily skewed upwards, after all.



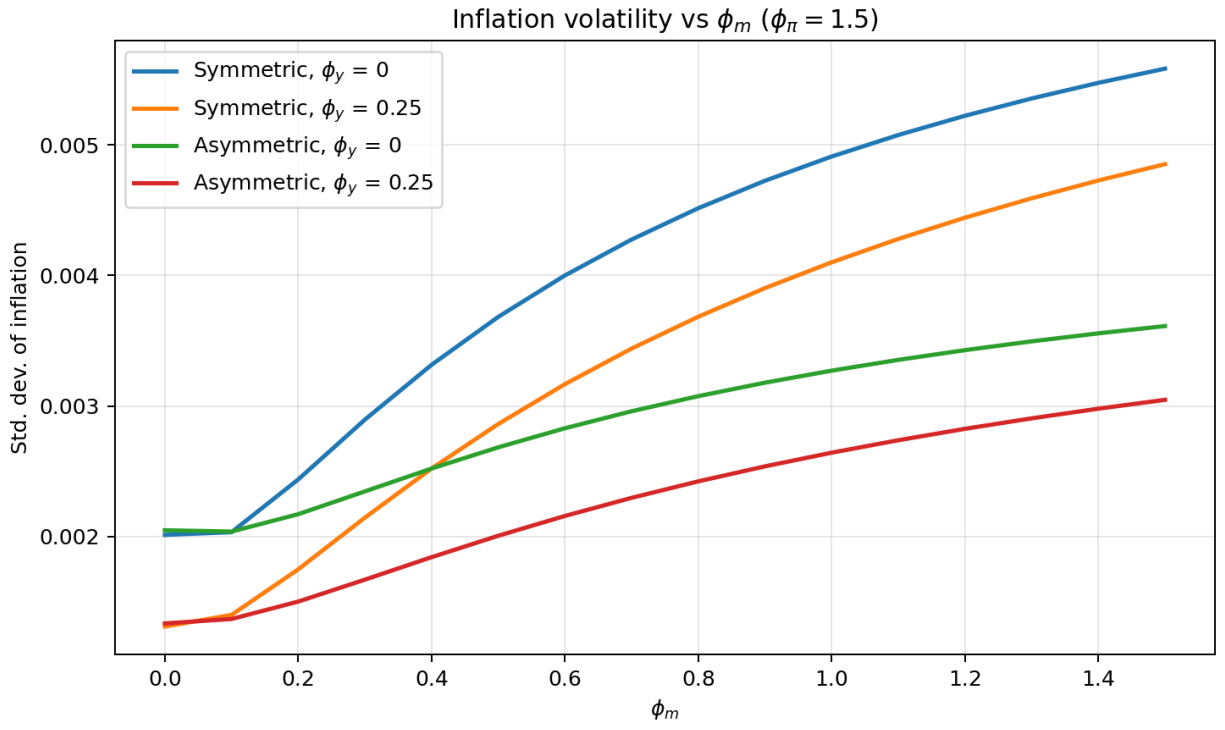


Figure 2: Inflation volatility different under monetary rules

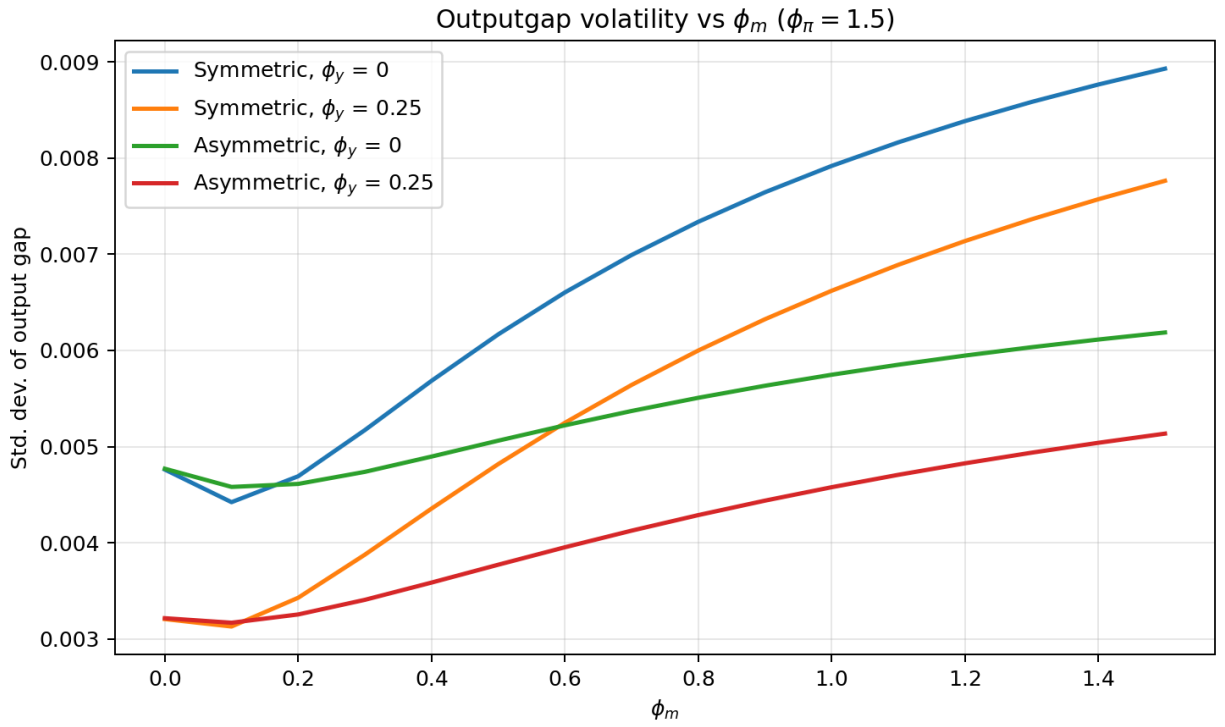


Figure 3: Output gap volatility different under monetary rules

Inflation outcomes are almost the exact opposite of asset price ones. In all settings the initial volatility response is mute, but quickly turns positive as  $\phi_m$  increases. In light of our closed-form solutions, we can know that this is due to the increasing financial contamination of real outcomes that the asset price response creates. In line with this, the asymmetric rule induces less volatility in inflation, as it means the central bank is reacting to financial shocks less often. This is further supported by the impulse response functions in the next section.

Finally, output gap outcomes are the most dynamic. Under  $\phi_y > 0$  the result is very similar to the ones found for inflation in 2. However, if there is no direct reaction to the output gap, a small positive  $\phi_m$  produces a *lower* volatility of the output gap. Again the closed form results help inform why that would happen: insofar as asset prices move due to real shocks, reacting to them acts as a partial, imperfect substitute to reacting to output. When the central bank does not (or cannot) react to the real economy, weakly reacting to asset prices becomes worthwhile. This comes with the cost of introducing financial shocks into the economy, and the tradeoff quickly turns sour.

Taking stock we gather the following lessons from these figures:

First, since high  $\phi_m$  delivers lower asset price volatility at the cost of higher output gap and inflation volatilities, it can be interpreted as a transfer of risk from financial assets to the real economy. Although our setup does not figure agent heterogeneity, in the real world this would be tantamount to insuring asset holding household returns at the expanse of non asset holding ones.

Second, a small positive  $\phi_m$  is actually desirable. For small values, it has no impact on output gap and inflation outcomes, as the effects of increasing reactivity to real shocks cancel out those of introducing financial disturbance in the economy; but even at these small values it lowers asset price volatility, and with it the price of risk. A central bank concerned with overall smoothness in the economy would be keen to explore this opportunity.

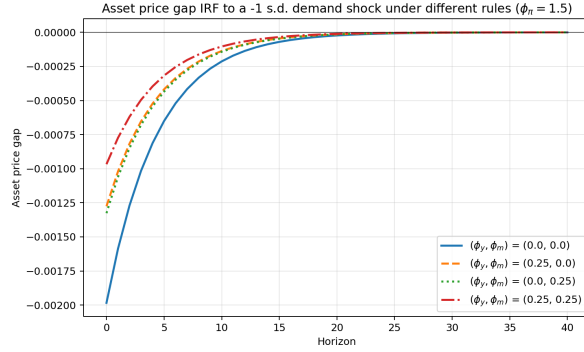
Third, that there are scenarios where positive, small  $\phi_m$  not only delivers the above gains, but actually reduces output gap volatility. In the model, these are the ones when the central bank sets  $\phi_y = 0$ . In real life, we can think of situations when there is limited information on  $\tilde{y}_t$  as ones where  $\phi_y$  is forcibly set to zero. In these cases, asset prices may deliver valuable information, especially if the central bank can be reasonably sure the economy is undergoing a real shock. Recent examples of this could include the COVID-19 lockdown, which demanded monetary reactions months before any real activity data would be available; or the 2025 tariff and 2026 oil shocks, which have slow moving but undoubtedly negative effect on supply, but immediately readable effects on asset prices.

## 4.2 Impulse Response Functions

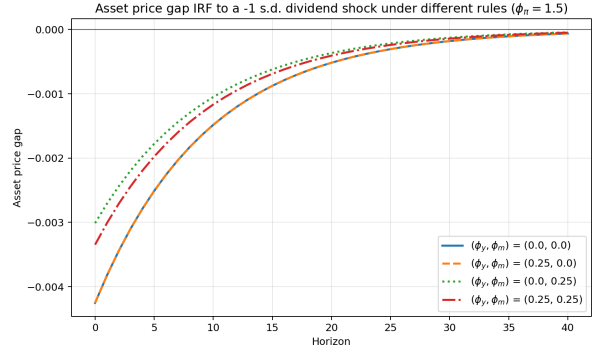
Impulse response functions add clarity to the previous results. Figures 4 through 6 make explicit the tradeoff of reacting to asset prices: *real* shocks in the form of demand and technology have reduced impacts on output gap, inflation and the asset price gap. *Financial* shocks in the form of dividends have reduced effects on asset prices, but become active for output and inflation, while they are neutral under  $\phi_m = 0$

They also show how, for real shocks, reacting only to asset prices and inflation is near-equivalent to reacting to the output gap and inflation instead, highlighting the eventual usefulness in doing so.

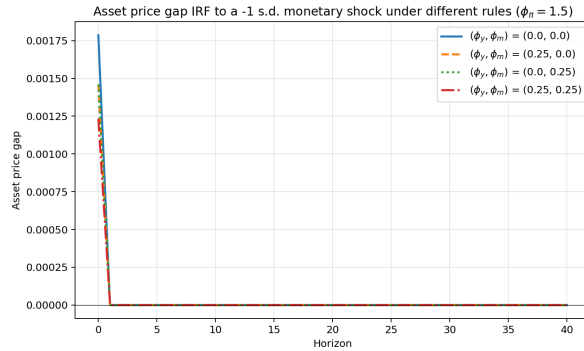
Taking together these help understand why the unconditional volatilities take the form they do as  $\phi_m$  increases (that is, flat or U-shaped for small  $\phi_m$  in inflation and output gap): The market-reacting rules dampen the inflation and output gap response of to real shocks, thus reducing their overall variability, and introduce a response to financial (here, dividend) shocks that were previously neutral, thus increasing it.



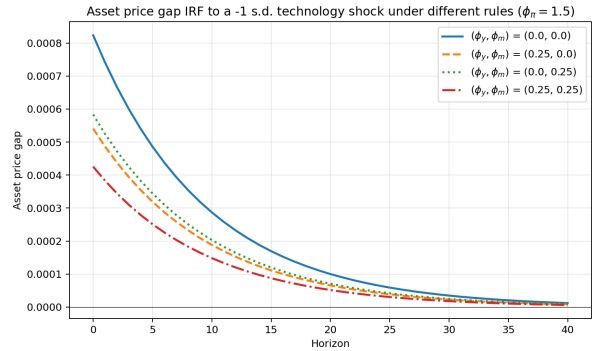
(a) Demand shock



(b) Dividend shock

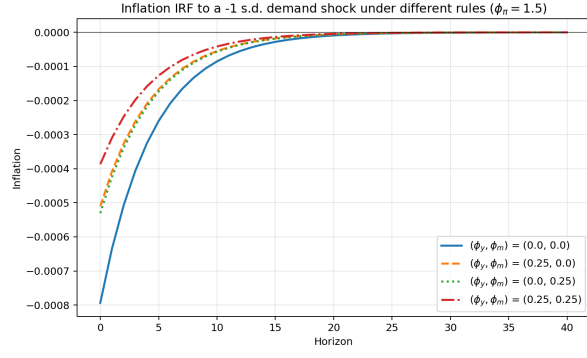


(c) Monetary shock

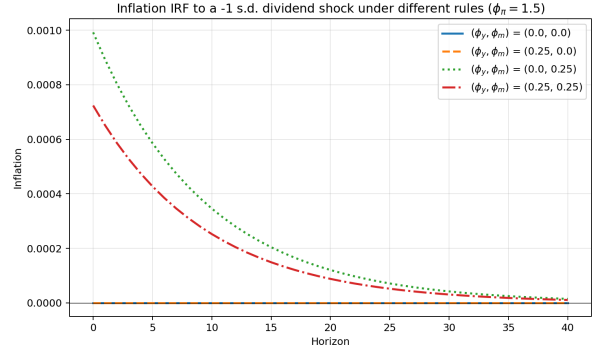


(d) Technology shock

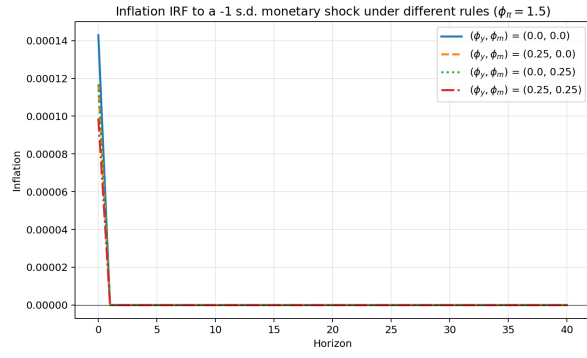
Figure 4: Impulse responses of asset price gap



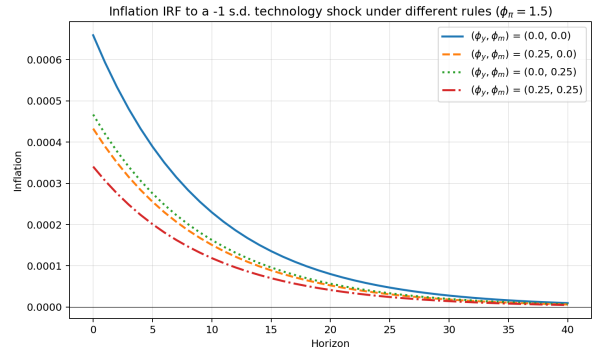
(a) Demand shock



(b) Dividend shock

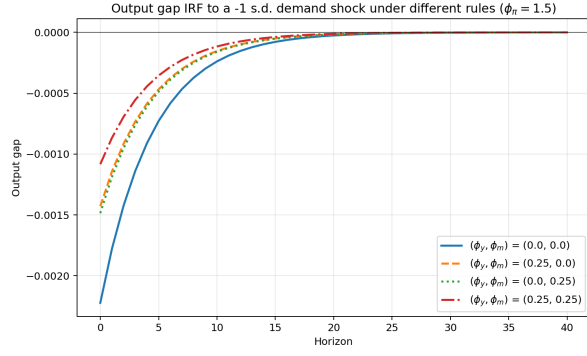


(c) Monetary shock

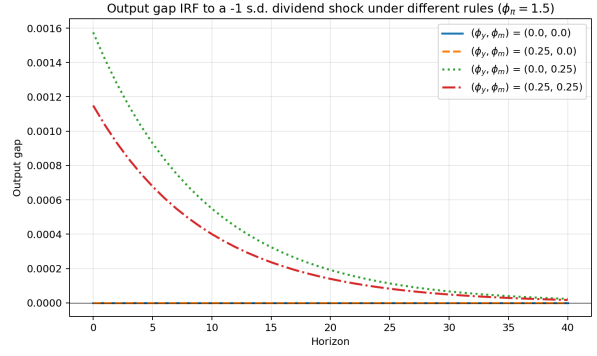


(d) Technology shock

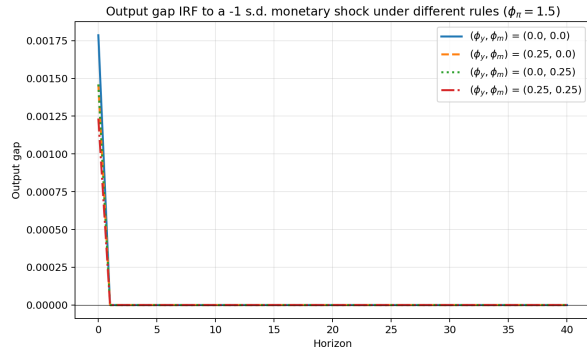
Figure 5: Impulse responses of inflation ( $\pi_t$ )



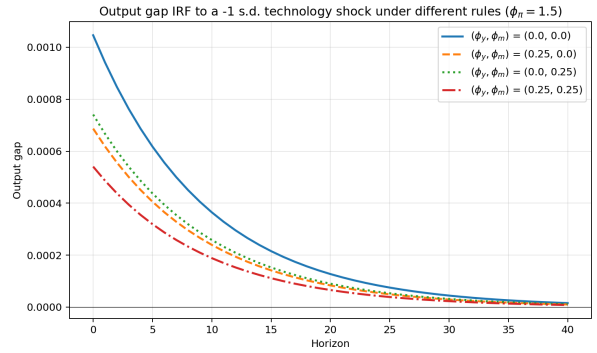
(a) Demand shock



(b) Dividend shock



(c) Monetary shock



(d) Technology shock

Figure 6: Impulse responses of output gap

### 4.3 What of monetary shocks?

To allow for cleaner identification of the monetary rule effect on the economy, all of the previous exercises were conducted under  $\rho_u = 0$ , meaning monetary shocks have no persistence. Since the rule itself has no inertial term, this means monetary shocks are essentially trivialized.

By setting  $\rho_u = 0.75$  we better approximate the persistence seen in interest rates. The results for economic volatility under different rules are qualitatively unchanged, but it has been said quantity has a quality of its own. As figure 7 makes clear, persistent monetary shocks significantly increase the value in reacting to asset prices in all settings. This highlights both the robustness and relevance of our previous results.

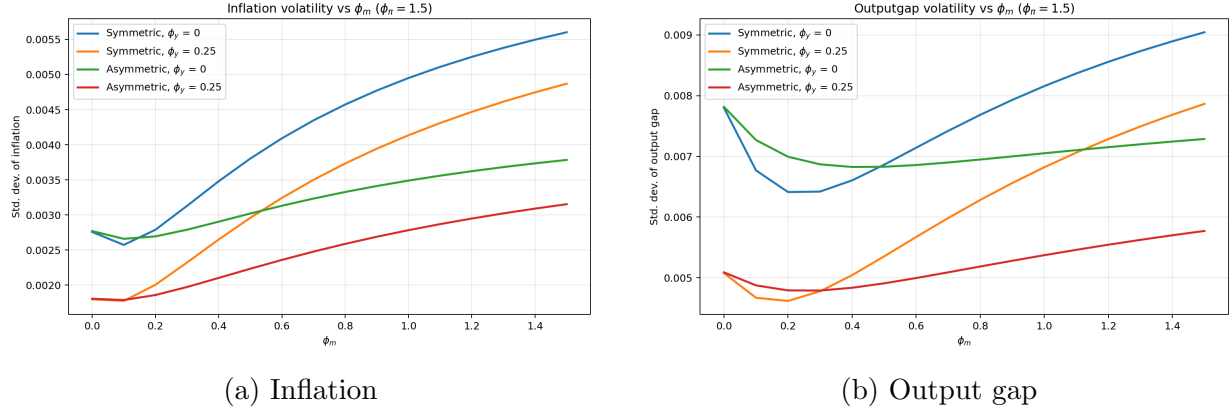


Figure 7: Economic volatility with persistent monetary shocks

## 5 Conclusion and Further Work

This draft set out to explore the effects of the Fed put in a simple new-keynesian production economy. Through a closed form solution for the symmetric rule we provide a better understanding of the mechanisms behind the seminal Bernanke & Gertler (2000) results. Then, via simulation methods we provide a more accurate treatment of the actual Fed put, i.e an asymmetric policy rule, and compare it to standard monetary rules.

These exercises cast doubt on those results. By exploring a more comprehensive set of parameters we see that there may be value in the put. At low sensitivities, responding to deviations in asset prices lowers asset price volatility while remaining neutral to inflation and output ones, thus delivering an overall smoother economy. Finally, we discuss scenarios in which adopting a small positive  $\phi_m$  reduces financial and real economic volatility, namely when information on real output is for some reason unavailable.

We also show that the rule the literature usually explores is too harsh. A true "Fed put" would have the central bank reacting only to shortfalls in asset prices, not windfalls. By making the central bank more parsimonious, we show that this type of rule tends to generate better results than the symmetric one as measured by economic volatility.

In a full version of this paper we would seek to provide model determinacy results for the model, derive precise equivalencies between  $\phi_m$  and  $\phi_y$  for real shocks, and identify optimal rule parameters  $(\phi_\pi, \phi_y, \phi_m)$ . After that, two avenues suggest themselves:

The more immediate one is to do with how we are modeling the asset market. First, we could come closer to the production economy asset pricing literature by adding firm capital and pricing that instead of relying on the Lucas tree. This comes with the cost of losing control over financial shocks and parameters, and adding complications to a as-of-now

very simple and treatable model. Second, permitting persistence in the asset price volatility would bring us closer to real market process. Third, as of now our setup cannot generate significant changes in mean asset prices due to different policy rules, even as this is one of the key aspects of the Fed put discussion. Overcoming this limitation would allow for interesting new results, and could be done by extending the work done by Pastore (2026) to include a richer macro block.

Another route is to explore agent heterogeneity. Adopting an OLG setup creates a channel through which the "tree" we planted in this economy directly affects consumption, and thus output. This would both enrich our results and allow for a wealth effect of market valuations to depress or enhance consumption. A mechanism like that would resemble the one the Fed believes acts in the American economy.

## A Closed-form Solution of the Symmetric Model

As demand and technology shocks are summarized by the natural rate, we proceed by treating it as an exogenous process instead of treating each shock separately. This makes for a cleaner derivation throughout. Also in the spirit of simplification we solve the model under  $d^{ss} = 0$ .

Consider the linearized system

$$\tilde{y}_t = E_t \tilde{y}_{t+1} - \frac{1}{\sigma} (i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n), \quad (27)$$

$$\pi_t = \beta E_t \pi_{t+1} + \kappa \tilde{y}_t, \quad (28)$$

$$\tilde{m}_t = \mu E_t \tilde{m}_{t+1} + (1 - \mu) E_t \tilde{d}_{t+1} - (i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n), \quad (29)$$

$$i_t = \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_y \tilde{y}_t + \phi_m \tilde{m}_t + u_t. \quad (30)$$

(We omit the steady-state constant from the policy rule, since it plays no role for deviations from steady state.)

Because the model is linear, one may solve it one shock at a time and then add the resulting components. Let  $s_t$  denote a generic AR(1) state,

$$s_t = \lambda s_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t, \quad E_t s_{t+1} = \lambda s_t, \quad (31)$$

and suppose that it enters the model through

$$r_t^n = \eta s_t, \quad u_t = \xi s_t, \quad (1 - \mu) E_t \tilde{d}_{t+1} = \nu \lambda s_t. \quad (32)$$

The three cases of interest are:

| Shock                       | $\eta$ | $\xi$ | $\nu$     |
|-----------------------------|--------|-------|-----------|
| Natural-rate shock $r_t^n$  | 1      | 0     | 0         |
| Monetary policy shock $u_t$ | 0      | 1     | 0         |
| Dividend shock $d_t$        | 0      | 0     | $1 - \mu$ |

where in the dividend case the state is  $s_t = \tilde{d}_t$  itself.

Seek a solution of the form

$$\tilde{y}_t = A_y s_t, \quad \pi_t = A_\pi s_t, \quad \tilde{m}_t = A_m s_t. \quad (33)$$

Then

$$E_t \tilde{y}_{t+1} = \lambda A_y s_t, \quad E_t \pi_{t+1} = \lambda A_\pi s_t, \quad E_t \tilde{m}_{t+1} = \lambda A_m s_t. \quad (34)$$



Substituting the policy rule into the IS curve yields

$$A_y s_t = \lambda A_y s_t - \frac{1}{\sigma} \left[ (\phi_\pi - \lambda) A_\pi + \phi_y A_y + \phi_m A_m + \xi - \eta \right] s_t, \quad (35)$$

so that

$$[\sigma(1 - \lambda) + \phi_y] A_y + (\phi_\pi - \lambda) A_\pi + \phi_m A_m = \eta - \xi. \quad (36)$$

From the NKPC,

$$A_\pi = \beta \lambda A_\pi + \kappa A_y \implies A_\pi = \frac{\kappa}{1 - \beta \lambda} A_y. \quad (37)$$

Now define the real-rate gap

$$x_t \equiv i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n. \quad (38)$$

Using the IS curve,

$$x_t = \sigma (E_t \tilde{y}_{t+1} - \tilde{y}_t) = -\sigma(1 - \lambda) A_y s_t. \quad (39)$$

Substituting this into asset pricing gives

$$A_m s_t = \mu \lambda A_m s_t + \nu \lambda s_t + \sigma(1 - \lambda) A_y s_t, \quad (40)$$

that is,

$$A_m = \frac{\nu \lambda + \sigma(1 - \lambda) A_y}{1 - \mu \lambda}. \quad (41)$$

Replacing (37) and (41) into (36) yields

$$\left[ \sigma(1 - \lambda) + \phi_y \right] A_y + (\phi_\pi - \lambda) \frac{\kappa}{1 - \beta \lambda} A_y + \phi_m \frac{\nu \lambda + \sigma(1 - \lambda) A_y}{1 - \mu \lambda} = \eta - \xi. \quad (42)$$

Multiplying through by  $(1 - \beta \lambda)(1 - \mu \lambda)$  and collecting terms in  $A_y$  gives

$$\begin{aligned} A_y & \left\{ (1 - \mu \lambda) \left[ \kappa(\phi_\pi - \lambda) + (1 - \beta \lambda)(\phi_y + \sigma(1 - \lambda)) \right] + (1 - \beta \lambda) \phi_m \sigma(1 - \lambda) \right\} \\ & = (1 - \beta \lambda) \left[ (1 - \mu \lambda)(\eta - \xi) - \phi_m \nu \lambda \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (43)$$

Define

$$\Delta(\lambda) \equiv (1 - \mu \lambda) \left[ \kappa(\phi_\pi - \lambda) + (1 - \beta \lambda)(\phi_y + \sigma(1 - \lambda)) \right] + (1 - \beta \lambda) \phi_m \sigma(1 - \lambda). \quad (44)$$

Then the output-gap coefficient is

$$A_y(\lambda; \eta, \xi, \nu) = \frac{(1 - \beta\lambda) \left[ (1 - \mu\lambda)(\eta - \xi) - \phi_m \nu \lambda \right]}{\Delta(\lambda)}. \quad (45)$$

From (37),

$$A_\pi(\lambda; \eta, \xi, \nu) = \frac{\kappa \left[ (1 - \mu\lambda)(\eta - \xi) - \phi_m \nu \lambda \right]}{\Delta(\lambda)}. \quad (46)$$

Finally, substituting  $A_y$  back into (41), one obtains

$$A_m(\lambda; \eta, \xi, \nu) = \frac{\nu \lambda \left[ \kappa(\phi_\pi - \lambda) + (1 - \beta\lambda)(\phi_y + \sigma(1 - \lambda)) \right] + \sigma(1 - \lambda)(1 - \beta\lambda)(\eta - \xi)}{\Delta(\lambda)}. \quad (47)$$

Hence the coefficients under each shock are obtained by substitution:

$$\text{Natural-rate shock } (\lambda, \eta, \xi, \nu) = (\rho_r, 1, 0, 0), \quad (48)$$

$$\text{Monetary shock } (\lambda, \eta, \xi, \nu) = (\rho_u, 0, 1, 0), \quad (49)$$

$$\text{Dividend shock } (\lambda, \eta, \xi, \nu) = (\rho_d, 0, 0, 1 - \mu). \quad (50)$$

In particular,

$$A_y^{(r)} = \frac{(1 - \beta\rho_r)(1 - \mu\rho_r)}{\Delta(\rho_r)}, \quad A_\pi^{(r)} = \frac{\kappa(1 - \mu\rho_r)}{\Delta(\rho_r)}, \quad A_m^{(r)} = \frac{\sigma(1 - \rho_r)(1 - \beta\rho_r)}{\Delta(\rho_r)}, \quad (51)$$

$$A_y^{(u)} = -\frac{(1 - \beta\rho_u)(1 - \mu\rho_u)}{\Delta(\rho_u)}, \quad A_\pi^{(u)} = -\frac{\kappa(1 - \mu\rho_u)}{\Delta(\rho_u)}, \quad A_m^{(u)} = -\frac{\sigma(1 - \rho_u)(1 - \beta\rho_u)}{\Delta(\rho_u)}, \quad (52)$$

$$A_y^{(d)} = -\frac{(1 - \beta\rho_d)\phi_m(1 - \mu)\rho_d}{\Delta(\rho_d)}, \quad A_\pi^{(d)} = -\frac{\kappa\phi_m(1 - \mu)\rho_d}{\Delta(\rho_d)}, \quad A_m^{(d)} = \frac{(1 - \mu)\rho_d}{\Delta(\rho_d)} \left[ \kappa(\phi_\pi - \rho_d) \right. \\ \left. + (1 - \beta\rho_d)(\phi_y + \sigma(1 - \rho_d)) \right] \quad (53)$$

## B Parameters Used in Calibration

Here we provide our model parameters. At this stage we have calibrated directly the parameters that appear in the final log-linearized solution rather than the full primitive set of parameters.:

Table 1: Model Calibration

| Parameter                 | Description                               | Value |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------|
| Structural Parameters     |                                           |       |
| $\beta$                   | Discount factor                           | 0.97  |
| $\mu$                     | Steady-state price-dividend ratio         | 0.97  |
| $\sigma$                  | Risk aversion / intertemporal elasticity  | 1.00  |
| $\kappa$                  | Phillips curve slope                      | 0.08  |
| $\psi_{ya}^n$             | Natural rate semi-elasticity (technology) | 1.00  |
| Shock Persistences        |                                           |       |
| $\rho_z$                  | Demand shock persistence                  | 0.80  |
| $\rho_a$                  | Technology shock persistence              | 0.90  |
| $\rho_d$                  | Dividend shock persistence                | 0.90  |
| $\rho_u$                  | Monetary shock persistence                | 0.75  |
| Shock Standard Deviations |                                           |       |
| $\sigma_z$                | Demand shock std. dev.                    | 0.005 |
| $\sigma_a$                | Technology shock std. dev.                | 0.005 |
| $\sigma_d$                | Dividend shock std. dev.                  | 0.020 |
| $\sigma_u$                | Monetary shock std. dev.                  | 0.002 |

## Appendix C. Equity "FED put" Model

This appendix presents a slight reformulation of the baseline model. Relative to the main text, the key change is on the asset side. Instead of introducing a Lucas tree as an exogenous risky claim, equity is now modeled as a claim on the profits of intermediate firms. This keeps the New Keynesian production structure while bringing the asset-pricing block closer to a production economy. The monetary rule is also written as a true level-gap Fed put: the central bank reacts to negative asset-price gaps, rather than to one-period declines alone.

The

### C.1 Environment

Time is discrete. The economy consists of a representative household, a competitive final-good sector, a continuum of monopolistically competitive intermediate firms, and a monetary authority. There is no capital accumulation and no private-sector financial friction.

### C.2 Households

The representative household chooses consumption  $C_t$ , labor supply  $N_t$ , nominal bond holdings  $B_{t+1}$ , and equity holdings  $S_{t+1}$  in order to maximize

$$E_0 \sum_{t=0}^{\infty} \beta^t [u(C_t) - v(N_t)], \quad 0 < \beta < 1.$$

Let  $\lambda_t$  denote the marginal utility of consumption.

The household budget constraint is

$$P_t C_t + B_{t+1} + Q_t S_{t+1} \leq (1 + i_{t-1}) B_t + (Q_t + D_t) S_t + W_t N_t - P_t T_t,$$

where  $Q_t$  is the nominal ex-dividend equity price and  $D_t$  the dividend paid by firms. The net supply of equity is normalized to one.

Optimality conditions imply

$$u_c(C_t) = \lambda_t P_t, \quad v_N(N_t) = \lambda_t W_t,$$

$$\lambda_t = \beta E_t [\lambda_{t+1} (1 + i_t)], \quad \lambda_t Q_t = \beta E_t [\lambda_{t+1} (Q_{t+1} + D_{t+1})].$$

In real terms, the pricing equation for equity is

$$q_t = E_t[M_{t,t+1}(q_{t+1} + d_{t+1})], \quad M_{t,t+1} \equiv \beta \frac{\lambda_{t+1}}{\lambda_t}.$$

### C.3 Firms and dividends

Final-good firms are competitive and aggregate differentiated intermediate goods with a Dixit–Stiglitz technology. Intermediate firms produce using labor only and set prices subject to Calvo frictions. Equity is a claim on aggregate profits of intermediate firms. Real dividends therefore satisfy

$$d_t = \frac{\Pi_t}{P_t} = \int_0^1 \left[ \frac{P_t(j)}{P_t} Y_t(j) - w_t N_t(j) \right] dj.$$

Using aggregation and market clearing, this can be written in reduced form as

$$d_t = y_t - mc_t y_t.$$

A first-order approximation around the deterministic steady state yields

$$\hat{d}_t = \hat{y}_t - (\theta - 1) \hat{m} c_t.$$

Since  $\hat{y}_t = x_t + \hat{y}_t^n$  and marginal cost is proportional to the output gap in the simple New Keynesian benchmark, the dividend block becomes

$$\hat{d}_t = \hat{y}_t^n + [1 - (\theta - 1)\omega] x_t,$$

where  $\omega$  is the elasticity of marginal cost with respect to the output gap.

### C.4 Natural allocation and private-sector block

Let  $y_t^n$  denote natural output and  $x_t \equiv y_t - y_t^n$  the output gap. Let  $r_t^n$  denote the natural real rate.

Without habits, the log-linear IS curve is

$$x_t = E_t x_{t+1} - \frac{1}{\sigma} (i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n).$$

Without indexation, inflation obeys the standard forward-looking Phillips curve

$$\pi_t = \beta E_t \pi_{t+1} + \kappa x_t.$$

The log-linear equity-pricing equation is

$$\hat{q}_t = \beta E_t \hat{q}_{t+1} + (1 - \beta) E_t \hat{d}_{t+1} - (i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n).$$

Thus the asset price depends on expected future dividends and on the real-rate gap.

## C.5 Monetary policy

The benchmark monetary rule is

$$i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} = \bar{r}_t + \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_x x_t,$$

where the monetary component follows

$$\bar{r}_t = \rho_m \bar{r}_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t^m.$$

This is the only persistent exogenous process retained in the simplified version.

The symmetric asset-price rule is

$$i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} = \bar{r}_t + \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_x x_t - \phi_q \hat{q}_t.$$

The true Fed put is written as a level-gap rule:

$$i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} = \bar{r}_t + \phi_\pi \pi_t + \phi_x x_t - \phi_q g_t, \quad g_t \equiv \min\{0, \hat{q}_t\}.$$

Hence, if equity prices are at or above steady state,  $g_t = 0$  and policy coincides with the benchmark. If equity prices are below steady state,  $g_t < 0$ , so policy eases relative to baseline. The accommodation remains active for as long as the asset-price gap is negative.

## C.6 Final equilibrium system

The model is summarized by

$$x_t = E_t x_{t+1} - \frac{1}{\sigma} (i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n),$$

$$\pi_t = \beta E_t \pi_{t+1} + \kappa x_t,$$

$$\hat{d}_t = \hat{y}_t^n + [1 - (\theta - 1)\omega] x_t,$$

$$\hat{q}_t = \beta E_t \hat{q}_{t+1} + (1 - \beta) E_t \hat{d}_{t+1} - (i_t - E_t \pi_{t+1} - r_t^n),$$

$$\bar{r}_t = \rho_m \bar{r}_{t-1} + \varepsilon_t^m,$$

together with one of the three policy rules above: benchmark, symmetric level-gap response, or asymmetric level-gap Fed put.

## C.7 Solution

The benchmark and symmetric specifications are linear rational-expectations systems and can be solved with standard linear methods. The asymmetric specification is nonlinear because of

$$g_t = \min\{0, \hat{q}_t\},$$

so it requires numerical methods such as piecewise-linear or perfect-foresight algorithms. This preserves a clean distinction between the analytically tractable benchmark and the economically relevant nonlinear rule.